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GENERAL STUDIES – MINI_MIH TEST 1 : 4140

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Center	ONLINE	Date	15 th /JULY/26

INDEX TABLE

Q. No.	Maximum Marks	Marks Obtained
1	15	
2	15	
3	15	
4	15	
5	10	
6	10	
7	10	
8	10	
9	10	
10	10	

Total Marks Obtained:

Remarks:

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Do furnish the appropriate details in the answer sheet (viz. Name, Registration Number and Test Code).
2. There are TEN questions printed in ENGLISH.
3. All questions are compulsory.
4. The number of marks carried by a question/part is indicated against it.
5. Answers must be written in the medium authorized in the Admission Certificate, which must be stated clearly on the cover of this Question-Cum-Answer (QCA) Booklet in the space provided. No marks will be given for answers written in medium other than the authorized one.
6. Word limit in questions, if specified, should be adhered to.
7. Any page or portion of the page left blank in the Question-Cum-Answer Booklet must be clearly struck off.

Is student recommended for One-to-One mentoring?

Recommended

Strongly Recommended

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EVALUATION INDICATORS

1. Contextual Competence
2. Content Competence
3. Language Competence
4. Introduction Competence
5. Structure - Presentation Competence
6. Conclusion Competence

Overall Macro Comments / feedback / suggestions on Answer Booklet:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

6.

All the Best

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1.

Giving a brief overview of the three Carnatic Wars, discuss the factors that led to the success of the British against the French in the struggle for control over India. (Answer in 250 words) 15

तीन कर्नाटक युद्धों का संक्षिप्त विवरण देते हुए, उन कारकों पर चर्चा कीजिए, जिनके कारण भारत पर नियंत्रण के लिए संघर्ष में फ्रांसीसियों के विरुद्ध अंग्रेजों को सफलता प्राप्त हुई।

Overview - The Carnatic wars cannot be seen as merely military conflicts between the two European trading companies. They represented the emergence of a new model of Imperialism with the use of diplomacy, military alliance and selective intervention in succession disputes as instruments of territorial conquest.

What began as a commercial rivalry soon turned into a struggle for political supremacy, fundamentally altering the balance of power in 18th century India.

Success of British against French - The British success against French cannot be explained merely through military victories or individual leadership. Rather it was part of larger institutional transformation of East India Company (EIC) involving institutional flexibility, naval superiority, and financial resources.

Factors led to British Succ.

① Military Organization

a) Numbers over strength -

a) Discipline over numbers - Seige of Arcot (1751)

- Clive was able to capture Arcot against overwhelming odds through the use of strategic military intervention and tactical innovation and a disciplined infantry.

b) Naval Power - EIC's superior navy enabled uninterrupted communication with Europe which helped in reinforcement of troops and securing maritime trade as well.

② Political Pragmatism - The English displayed better skills at forging alliances.

③ Institutional Flexibility - Due to the private nature of EIC, decision making was swift as compared to its French counterpart.

④ Recall of Duplex - Duplex was a master strategy maker and after his recall in 1754, no effective strategy was formulated.

⑤ Weak leadership under ~~Eyres Coote~~ - French
governor ~~Eyres Coe~~ Count De Lally

Count De Lally did not cooperated even with his
own unit.

Despite the political vision of Duplex and early
military successes, French authority steadily
eroded after Seige of Arcot (1751) & Recall
of Duplex (1754), exposing deeper structural
weaknesses of French which ultimately
ensured British supremacy after Treaty of
Paris (1763).

2.

"The conquest of Awadh happened in stages and its annexation not only displaced the Nawab, but dispossessed the taluqdars and led to the breakdown of an entire social order". Discuss. (Answer in 250 words) 15

"अवध को कई चरणों में जीता गया और इसके विलय ने न केवल नवाब को पदच्युत किया अपितु तालुकदारों को भी बेदखल किया तथा यह संपूर्ण सामाजिक व्यवस्था के भंग होने का कारण भी बना।" चर्चा कीजिए।

3.

Colonialism in India gained foothold in distinct stages with debilitating impact on the Indian economy. Discuss. (Answer in 250 words) 15

भारतीय अर्थव्यवस्था को प्रतिकूल रूप से प्रभावित करते हुए, भारत में उपनिवेशवाद ने विभिन्न चरणों में अपना आधार मज़बूत किया। चर्चा कीजिए।

4.

The Marathas were capable of filling the political vacuum created by the disintegration of Mughal empire in the 18th century, but they failed to do so. Explain. (Answer in 250 words) 15

मराठे 18वीं शताब्दी में मुगल साम्राज्य के विघटन से उत्पन्न राजनीतिक शून्यता को भर पाने में सक्षम थे, किन्तु वे ऐसा कर पाने में विफल रहे। व्याख्या कीजिए।

- 4) The policies of Marathas scarcely went beyond the collection of chauth and Sardeshmukhi. Despite the annexation of areas such as Malwa, Orissa, Bundelkhand, Marathas did not place any semblance of administration which always kept the annexed areas under external threat.

The dynamics of Maratha Kingdom post 1707

① Balaji Vishwanath successfully aided Sayyid Brothers in eliminating Farrukhsiyar as well as able to secure the Mughal order of Marathas' right to chauth and Sardeshmukhi.

② Balaji Vishwanath made changes to the Maratha confederacy system - "Sarajemi System" whereby he made the land grant permanent in nature. This led to emergence of 5 Maratha houses - Peshwas of Poona,

Holkars of Indore, Scindias of Gwalior, Bhonsles of Nagpur & Gaikwads of Baroda.

This political divide within Maratha system planted the seed of "Power tussle" which eventually lead to Maratha destabilization.

③ Lack of sophisticated weapons & army - Marathas, despite militarily very strong and large in numbers, they were thoroughly defeated by Abdali in the Third Battle of Panipat (1761) as Abdali used SWIVEL GUNS which operated from the humps of Camel.

④ Breaking of line of Succession of Peshwa ship - Even after the Maratha glory was subdued till 1771, Ragunath Rao performed cold blooded murder of Peshwa Narayan Rao (Younger brother of Peshwa Balaji Raji Rao) and signed a secret treaty with British - "Treaty of Surat (1775)" paving the way for 1st Anglo Maratha War (1776-82).

⑤ Regency of Nana Fadnis - Sawai Madhav Rao commits suicide & the new Peshwa again performs a cold blooded murder of Tukoji Rao Holkar. These events were perfectly "ripe" for British to start filling the political vacuum which Marathas failed to do.

⑥ Treaty of Bassein / Subsidiary Alliance system - The fortified Peshwa trades security for the independence & sovereignty of Marathas. This was the key for British to Central India.

Thus, the strong intention to integrate India as well as going beyond tax collection policies, were both missing from Maratha's mindset, enabling British to enter a politically divided landscape where diplomacy mattered as much as battlefield successes.

5.

The Governor-Generalship of Lord Wellesley is known for expansion of British power in India. Why did Wellesley decide to pursue the policy of expansion? Also account for the methods adopted by him to achieve the same. (Answer in 150 words) 10

गवर्नर-जनरल के रूप में लॉर्ड वेल्लेज़ली का कार्यकाल भारत में ब्रिटिश सत्ता के विस्तार के लिए जाना जाता है। वेल्लेज़ली ने विस्तार-नीति को अपनाने का निर्णय क्यों लिया? इसकी प्राप्ति हेतु उसके द्वारा अपनाई गयी विधियों का विवरण भी प्रस्तुत कीजिए।

The strategy once introduced by French Governor Duplex in 1740s were perfected by Richard Wellesley when he was appointed as Governor General in 1798.

① Wellesley decided to pursue the policy of expansion so as to anticipate the weaknesses of an "already divided India among religious lines".

- └ Marathas wanted to establish a Hindu Kingdom "Hindu Pad Pad Shahi".
- └ Mysore wanted to become a big Islamic Kingdom.
- └ Baluch tribe (Talpur Amir) of Sindh province.
- └ Sikh Community / Khanda state of Punjab.

② Additionally, this was not a standalone policy, rather it was seen as an evolution of Warren Hastings' Policy of Ring Fence.

③ The policy of Ring Fence pushed several states like Awadh into a "debt Trap" & the subsidiary alliance system chipped off territories on default of payment.

6.

Trace the evolution of East India Company's relations with the British State from 1765 to 1833. (Answer in 150 words) 10

1765 से 1833 तक ब्रिटिश राज के साथ ईस्ट इंडिया कंपनी के संबंधों के विकास का पता लगाइए।

By the mid 18th century, East India Company (EIC) evolved beyond a trading corporation into a territorial sovereign. The 1765 acquisition of Diwani directed the Bengal's revenue into EIC's treasury which enabled Company officials to even influence the Britain's government. Thus the EC needed control to prevent it from dominating Britain's parliament, threatening British liberties and to address this the parliament passed a series of regulations & Acts beginning with Regulating act of 1773.

Evolution of EIC's relation with British State

① British State also wanted to reap the benefits of Indian plunder → obligates EIC to pay £4,00,000 annually to Crown.

② Bankrupt EIC applied for a 1 million pound loan in Britain, enabling the parliament to check Company's accounts.

- ② Regulating Act, 1773 - The 24 Court of Directors placed under supervision of Crown.
- ④ The legislative powers of Governor and his Council gradually strengthened from 1773 to 1833.
- ③ Supreme Court of Calcutta created in 1774, renders EIC's existing Courts in Bengal inferior.
- ⑥ The Company's trading privileges were drastically reduced to zero from the Act of 1813 to 1833.
- ⑦ Subsequent charter Acts not only absorbed the executive power of EIC but also weakened EIC's financial arm by abolishing Mughal Adalats, getting 5% Shareholder dividend from Indian revenue, salaries of high officials etc. from Indian rev.
- Thus, the British state gradually progressively subordinated EIC through consecutive legislations and eventually transformed it into an administrative agency of British Empire.

7.

Highlight the major weaknesses and reasons behind the decline of Later Mughals.
(Answer in 150 words) 10

उत्तरकालीन मुगलों की प्रमुख कमजोरियों और उनके पतन के लिए उत्तरदायी कारणों पर प्रकाश डालिए।

The death of Aurangzeb in 1707 started the prolonged decline of Mughal Empire. Though the Empire survived for another 150 years, its authority steadily weakened due to internal politics and external pressures.

Decline of Later Mughals (1707-1858)

① Political reasons -

- a) Weak successors after Aurangzeb.
- b) Constant invasions of Afghani & Nadir Shah beginning from 1739.
- c) Civil factions among Mughal nobles.
 - d) Mughal Nobles emerging as king makers & some even establishing fully autonomous states such as Est. of Hyderabad by Asaf Jah in 1724.
- e) No clear line of succession in later Mughals leading to political instability.

② Military reasons - Mughal army was largely Cavalry based with no standardised training.

The weak navy & lack of military reforms also contributed to overall military weakness.

③ Religious Causes - Faced resistance from Sikh under Banda Bahadur, Religious divisive policy of Aurangzeb & Discriminatory Jizya Tax triggered the religious sentiments of community.

④ Economic Causes - a) Costly deccan wars draining mughal wealth.

b) Financial demands for deccan wars leading to expansion of Khas land → Jagirdari Crises.

c) Revenue farming through Iqta System of taxation burdened peasants, reducing agricultural productivity & administrative inefficiency.

⑤ Fragmentation of Mughal polity by rise of regional states.

Thus, the decline of Mughals cannot be just attributed to a single ruler or event, rather it was a cumulative effect of administrative decay, financial crises and instable polity that paved the way for regional states & eventually Colonial domination.

8.

Enumerate the important features of Subsidiary Alliance policy during the British rule. How did this policy help in the expansion of the British rule in India? (Answer in 150 words) 10

ब्रिटिश शासन के दौरान सहायक संधि की नीति की महत्वपूर्ण विशेषताओं को सूचीबद्ध कीजिए। इस नीति ने भारत में ब्रिटिश शासन के विस्तार में किम प्रकार सहायता प्रदान की।

Features of Subsidiary Alliance System (SAS)

often referred to as "Trojan Horse tactic" for British expansion in India. Warren Hastings policy of ring fence evolved into SAS by Lord Richard Wellesley.

- ① The British will provide protection to the allied state from both foreign and domestic threats.
- ② A permanent regiment of British will be stationed in the native state.
- ③ The alliance partner cannot negotiate with any other state or foreign power without the consent of British authority.
- ④ The alliance to pay for the maintenance of British troops and upon default of payment, some part of the territory ~~was~~ will be chipped off as an equivalent payment.

- ⑤ A "resident" was stationed in the partner's court, often interfering in the native affairs of the alliance partner.

Utility of SAS in British expansion

- ① Ease of Control - Having a permanent troops of British in the state made it easier for British to even overthrow the ruler if required.
- ② Countering French influence - This policy greatly helped British in controlling French expansion.
- ③ Diplomatic edge - British often involved into the native affairs of state so as to satisfy its own mercantile interests.

"A state purchased security by the sacrifice of independence, of National unity and of whatever renders a people respectable".

— Sir Thomas Munro

Thus, British used a mix of policies (diplomatic, administrative & military) simultaneously which facilitated swift expansion of British Empire in India.

9.

The reactionary policies of Lord Lytton and the liberal policies of his successor Lord Rippon acted as catalyst in the formation of the Indian National Congress. Discuss. 10
(Answer in 150 words)

लॉर्ड लिटन की प्रतिक्रियावादी नीतियों और उसके उत्तराधिकारी लॉर्ड रिपन की उदार नीतियों ने भारतीय राष्ट्रीय कांग्रेस के गठन में उत्प्रेरक का कार्य किया। चर्चा कीजिए।

10.

The colonial forest policies were driven by the needs of the British Empire with no concern for the well-being of the locals and the environment. Discuss in the context of India. (Answer in 150 words) 10

औपनिवेशिक वन नीतियां स्थानीय लोगों के कल्याण और पर्यावरण की चिंता किए बिना ब्रिटिश साम्राज्य की जरूरतों से प्रेरित थीं। भारत के संदर्भ में चर्चा कीजिए।